

Food at a Restaurant - Complete Lesson

A2 · Ages Adults (20-23) · 60 min · Speaking · + Listening

Overview

Learning objective: Order a meal and a drink politely, respond to an unavailable item, and ask a server for the bill.

Main skill: Speaking

Secondary skill: Listening

Duration: 60 minutes

Class size: 20 students

Group work: Groups of 2

Success criteria

- Order a food and a drink politely.
- Choose an alternative when an item is unavailable.
- Ask for the bill and check the correct total.

Materials needed

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- Student worksheets A and B with reading and listening questions; teacher answer keys.
 - Supplied case and situation cards; paper and pens.
 - Printed materials and the teacher's voice.

Teacher preparation

- Read the two scripts and check the teacher keys before teaching.
- Print one selected worksheet version per learner; keep teacher copies separate.
- Prepare the supplied role cards. No outside article or paid material is needed.
- Use imaginary preferences. Do not ask learners to reveal allergies, income or private health information. Menu prices are fictional.

Key language

-
- menu
 - order
 - water
 - chicken

- bill
- I would like ____, please.
- Do you have ____?
- Could I have the bill, please?

Lesson plan - 60 minutes

5 min - Connect and set the goal

Teacher: Invite an initial view on the case, then state the objective and distinguish the fictional scenario from factual research.

Students: State an initial view and one question you want the case to answer.

Materials: Opening slide or printed opening card

Purpose: Activate prior knowledge without testing unfamiliar language.

8 min - Teach the five key words

Teacher: Model the five terms using their definitions and examples. Ask learners to explain a distinction in their own words.

Students: Complete Section A and compare meanings with a partner.

Materials: Vocabulary cards; worksheet Section A

Purpose: Listening supports the main speaking task.

10 min - Read for meaning

Teacher: Give a first reading for the main situation, followed by the four evidence questions. Clarify only vocabulary essential to meaning.

Students: Read the passage, answer the questions and locate the supporting words.

Materials: Reading passage and four questions, supplied in the worksheet

Purpose: Establish a shared context and check literal understanding before interpretation.

8 min - Listen for a change or decision

Teacher: Read the supplied listening script twice. First check the main situation; then read the three questions and repeat for details.

Students: Identify the main situation, then answer the three detail questions and compare evidence.

Materials: Supplied listening script and questions

Purpose: Practice listening with information that differs from the reading.

10 min - Guided language practice

Teacher: Use Version A Sections B and C. Model one response, then let pairs work. Keep Version B for a later lesson, reassessment or fast finishers. For children, Sections D and E are optional additional practice.

Students: Apply the sentence frames, then respond to the five application prompts.

Materials: Worksheet A; sentence frames; optional worksheet B

Purpose: Move from recognition to usable language.

15 min - Cedar Café role-play

Teacher: Arrange pairs and assign customer/server roles. Use the supplied menu and unavailable-soup condition. Model one request, then let partners exchange roles. Assess ordering, responding and checking the bill.

Students: Order a meal and drink, respond to the unavailable item, and check the bill. Swap customer and server roles.

Materials: All situation cards appear under Activities and on the student slides

Purpose: Demonstrate the objective through a purposeful exchange.

4 min - Exit check and next step

Teacher: Use the three exit prompts. Record which part of the objective needs another model. Explain the short homework; use the separate assessment later if needed.

Students: Give an independent response and identify one point to improve.

Materials: Exit ticket and homework instructions

Purpose: Check individual progress after supported group work.

Classroom activity - Cedar Café role-play

Objective: Order a meal and a drink politely, respond to an unavailable item, and ask a server for the bill.

Time: 15 minutes

Grouping: Groups of 2

Materials: Menu: Chicken with rice \$12; vegetable soup \$6; bean sandwich \$7; water \$2; orange juice \$3. Prices include all charges for this fictional activity.

Customer: You have \$15. Order food and a drink. Ask for the bill and check it.

Server: Soup is unavailable. Offer another dish. Repeat the order and calculate the total.

Teacher instructions

- Use the exact situation cards below; no additional resource is needed.
- Form groups of 2 and model one short response.

- Allow 10 minutes for preparation and practice; use the remaining time for responses and feedback.
- Score each criterion 0-2: orders a food and drink politely; responds appropriately to an unavailable item; asks for the bill and checks the total. 4/6 indicates the task is substantially met. Intelligibility matters more than a perfect accent. This is a task rubric, not formal CEFR certification.

Student instructions

- Menu: Chicken with rice \$12; vegetable soup \$6; bean sandwich \$7; water \$2; orange juice \$3. Prices include all charges for this fictional activity.
- Customer: You have \$15. Order food and a drink. Ask for the bill and check it.
- Server: Soup is unavailable. Offer another dish. Repeat the order and calculate the total.

Example: Customer: I would like soup and water, please. Server: Sorry, we do not have soup. Customer: The bean sandwich, then. Server: A bean sandwich and water. That is nine dollars.

Variation: Exchange recommendations with another group and write one constructive challenge.

Homework

Continue the learning

Use the lesson materials. No additional purchase or research is required.

- Write a six-line exchange at the café.
- Include one change of order and a correct total.

Estimated time: 10-15 minutes

Exit ticket - 4 min

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- Customer: Order two menu items and ask their total.
 - Server: Confirm chicken and water and state the total.
 - Name one point you would improve in your response.

Success looks like: Score each criterion 0-2: orders a food and drink politely; responds appropriately to an unavailable item; asks for the bill and checks the total. 4/6 indicates the task is substantially met. Intelligibility matters more than a perfect accent. This is a task rubric, not formal CEFR certification.

Teacher notes

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- Score each criterion 0-2: orders a food and drink politely; responds appropriately to an unavailable item; asks for the bill and checks the total. 4/6 indicates the task is substantially met. Intelligibility matters more than a perfect accent. This is a task rubric, not formal CEFR certification.
 - Reading and listening tell different stories. Keep their keys separate.
 - Student slides include tasks and language models. Facilitation notes and transcript answers belong in the separate teacher documents.

Student worksheet - Version A

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Complete the sections your teacher assigns. Use the reading and the supplied case details. Version B is an alternative for later practice.

Section A - Meet the key words

Match each definition to a word from the bank.

Word bank

menu | order | water | chicken | bill

1. A list of food and drinks.

2. Ask for food or drinks.

3. A drink.

4. A type of meat.

5. The list of what you need to pay.

Reading - Lunch at Cedar Café

Read the passage and answer the questions.

Cedar Café is a fictional practice restaurant. Its lunch menu is simple: chicken with rice costs \$12, vegetable soup costs \$6, and a bean sandwich costs \$7. Still water costs \$2 and orange juice costs \$3. The listed prices are the full prices for this classroom role-play; there are no extra charges.

Rosa arrives at one o'clock. She asks for the menu. She wants soup, but the server says there is no soup today. Rosa chooses the chicken with rice instead. She orders still water because she does not want juice.

After the meal, Rosa asks for the bill. The server brings it and Rosa checks the two items. She pays \$14 and says thank you.

1. Which food is unavailable?

2. What meal does Rosa choose?

3. Why does she order water?

4. How much does she pay?

Section B - Language in use

Respond using language that fits the situation.

1. Make this polite: Give me water.

2. You want chicken with rice. Place your order.

3. The soup is unavailable. Choose the bean sandwich.

4. Ask to see the list of dishes.

5. Your meal is finished. Ask to pay.

Section C - Apply and explain

Give a reason, an example or a case detail when the prompt asks for one.

1. Customer: Order two menu items and ask their total.

2. Server: Soup is unavailable. Offer two alternatives.

3. Customer: Change your drink from juice to water.

4. Server: Confirm chicken and water and state the total.

5. Customer: End the exchange politely.

Listening - A Changed Order

Listen for meaning, then answer the questions.

1. What does David first want to eat?

- a) Vegetable soup
- b) Chicken with rice
- c) A bean sandwich

2. What drink does he order?

- a) Orange juice
- b) Water
- c) Coffee

3. What is the final total?

- a) Ten dollars
- b) Nine dollars
- c) Fourteen dollars

Student worksheet - Version B

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Complete the sections your teacher assigns. Use the reading and the supplied case details. Version B is an alternative for later practice.

Section A - Use the key words

Write a sentence that shows each word's meaning.

Word bank

menu | order | water | chicken | bill

1. Use "menu" in a sentence about this lesson.

2. Use "order" in a sentence about this lesson.

3. Use "water" in a sentence about this lesson.

4. Use "chicken" in a sentence about this lesson.

5. Use "bill" in a sentence about this lesson.

Reading - Lunch at Cedar Café

Read the passage and answer the questions.

Cedar Café is a fictional practice restaurant. Its lunch menu is simple: chicken with rice costs \$12, vegetable soup costs \$6, and a bean sandwich costs \$7. Still water costs \$2 and orange juice costs \$3. The listed prices are the full prices for this classroom role-play; there are no extra charges.

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After the meal, Rosa asks for the bill. The server brings it and Rosa checks the two items. She pays \$14 and says thank you.

1. Which food is unavailable?

2. What meal does Rosa choose?

3. Why does she order water?

4. How much does she pay?

Section B - Language in use

Respond using language that fits the situation.

1. Ask whether the café has orange juice.

2. Order a bean sandwich and water.

3. You need another minute to choose. Tell the server.

4. Confirm an order of chicken and juice.

5. The bill includes soup you did not receive. Explain politely.

Section C - Apply and explain

Give a reason, an example or a case detail when the prompt asks for one.

1. Customer: Order chicken and juice.

2. Server: State the total for that order.

3. Customer: Ask to change chicken to a bean sandwich.

4. Server: Confirm the new total with juice.

5. Customer: Check and pay the bill.

Listening - A Changed Order

Listen for meaning, then answer the questions.

1. What does David first want to eat?

- a) Vegetable soup
- b) Chicken with rice
- c) A bean sandwich

2. What drink does he order?

- a) Orange juice
- b) Water
- c) Coffee

3. What is the final total?

- a) Ten dollars
- b) Nine dollars
- c) Fourteen dollars

Teacher answer key

How to run the worksheet

Order a meal and a drink politely, respond to an unavailable item, and ask a server for the bill.

Score each criterion 0-2: orders a food and drink politely; responds appropriately to an unavailable item; asks for the bill and checks the total. 4/6 indicates the task is substantially met. Intelligibility matters more than a perfect accent. This is a task rubric, not formal CEFR certification.

Group work guidance

Groups of 2; give everyone a speaking or checking role and rotate. Use Version B as alternate practice, not as a second full worksheet in the same session.

Answers - Version A

Section A - Meet the key words

1. A list of food and drinks. -> menu
2. Ask for food or drinks. -> order
3. A drink. -> water
4. A type of meat. -> chicken
5. The list of what you need to pay. -> bill

Teaching point: Check meaning before form.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Reading - Lunch at Cedar Café

1. Which food is unavailable? -> Vegetable soup.
2. What meal does Rosa choose? -> Chicken with rice.
3. Why does she order water? -> She does not want juice.
4. How much does she pay? -> \$14.

Teaching point: Use the passage, not outside knowledge.

Model answers: 1. Evidence: there is no soup today | 2. Evidence: Rosa chooses the chicken with rice instead. | 3. Evidence: She orders still water because she does not want juice. | 4. Evidence: She pays \$14 and says thank you.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Section B - Language in use

1. Make this polite: Give me water. -> Could I have some water, please?
2. You want chicken with rice. Place your order. -> I would like the chicken with rice, please.
3. The soup is unavailable. Choose the bean sandwich. -> I would like the bean sandwich instead, please.
4. Ask to see the list of dishes. -> Can I see the menu, please?
5. Your meal is finished. Ask to pay. -> Could I have the bill, please?

Teaching point: Speaking practice with listening support.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Section C - Apply and explain

1. Customer: Order two menu items and ask their total. -> Example: A bean sandwich and water, please. How much is that? Total: \$9.
2. Server: Soup is unavailable. Offer two alternatives. -> We do not have soup today. Would you like chicken with rice or a bean sandwich?
3. Customer: Change your drink from juice to water. -> Could I have water instead of juice, please?
4. Server: Confirm chicken and water and state the total. -> Chicken with rice and water. That is \$14.
5. Customer: End the exchange politely. -> Thank you. Have a nice day.

Teaching point: Speaking practice with listening support.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Listening - A Changed Order

1. What does David first want to eat? -> Vegetable soup
2. What drink does he order? -> Orange juice
3. What is the final total? -> Ten dollars

Teaching point: Read or listen twice. Answers refer only to this script.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Teacher transcript:

Welcome to Cedar Café. I am your server today. A customer named David sits at a small table by the window. He asks for the menu, and I give it to him. He looks at the food and drinks for a minute.

David says he would like vegetable soup and a glass of orange juice. I explain that we do not have soup today. We have chicken with rice or a bean sandwich. David thinks for a moment. Then he says, I would like the bean sandwich, please. I repeat his order: one bean sandwich and one orange juice. He says that is right.

I bring the juice first. A few minutes later, I bring the sandwich. David asks for a little more time before he pays. I say that is fine. After he finishes his meal, he asks for the bill. The sandwich is seven dollars, and the juice is three dollars. The total is ten dollars. There are no extra charges in this practice café. David checks the bill, pays ten dollars, and thanks me. I thank him too. He leaves the café and walks back to his class.

Read the questions aloud for young learners. Replay or reread in short sections if needed.

Answers - Version B

Section A - Use the key words

1. Use "menu" in a sentence about this lesson. -> Can I see the menu, please?
2. Use "order" in a sentence about this lesson. -> I would like to order.
3. Use "water" in a sentence about this lesson. -> Still water, please.
4. Use "chicken" in a sentence about this lesson. -> I would like the chicken.
5. Use "bill" in a sentence about this lesson. -> Can I have the bill, please?

Teaching point: Check meaning before form.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Reading - Lunch at Cedar Café

1. Which food is unavailable? -> Vegetable soup.
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Teaching point: Use the passage, not outside knowledge.

Model answers: 1. Evidence: there is no soup today | 2. Evidence: Rosa chooses the chicken with rice instead. | 3. Evidence: She orders still water because she does not want juice. | 4. Evidence: She pays \$14 and says thank you.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Section B - Language in use

1. Ask whether the café has orange juice. -> Do you have orange juice?
2. Order a bean sandwich and water. -> I would like a bean sandwich and water, please.
3. You need another minute to choose. Tell the server. -> Could I have another minute, please?
4. Confirm an order of chicken and juice. -> Yes, chicken and orange juice. That is right.
5. The bill includes soup you did not receive. Explain politely. -> Excuse me, I did not have soup. Could you check the bill, please?

Teaching point: Speaking practice with listening support.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Section C - Apply and explain

1. Customer: Order chicken and juice. -> Chicken with rice and orange juice, please.
2. Server: State the total for that order. -> \$15, please.
3. Customer: Ask to change chicken to a bean sandwich. -> Could I have the bean sandwich instead, please?
4. Server: Confirm the new total with juice. -> A bean sandwich and orange juice: \$10.
5. Customer: Check and pay the bill. -> The sandwich and juice are \$10. Here you are. Thank you.

Teaching point: Speaking practice with listening support.

Common errors: Answering a different question or giving a claim without the requested detail.

Corrections: Return to the exact prompt. Accept accurate equivalent wording for open responses.

Notes: Answers are in item order. Model responses are examples, not the only acceptable wording.

Listening - A Changed Order

1. What does David first want to eat? -> Vegetable soup
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Teaching point: Read or listen twice. Answers refer only to this script.

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Notes: Teacher transcript:

Welcome to Cedar Café. I am your server today. A customer named David sits at a small table by the window. He asks for the menu, and I give it to him. He looks at the food and drinks for a minute.

David says he would like vegetable soup and a glass of orange juice. I explain that we do not have soup today. We have chicken with rice or a bean sandwich. David thinks for a moment. Then he says, I would like the bean sandwich, please. I repeat his order: one bean sandwich and one orange juice. He says that is right.

I bring the juice first. A few minutes later, I bring the sandwich. David asks for a little more time before he pays. I say that is fine. After he finishes his meal, he asks for the bill. The sandwich is seven dollars, and the juice is three dollars. The total is ten dollars. There are no extra charges in this practice café. David checks the bill, pays ten dollars, and thanks me. I thank him too. He leaves the café and walks back to his class.

Read the questions aloud for young learners. Replay or reread in short sections if needed.

Assessment answers

-
1. Customer: Order two menu items and ask their total.

Answer: Example: A bean sandwich and water, please. How much is that? Total: \$9.

2. Server: Soup is unavailable. Offer two alternatives.

Answer: We do not have soup today. Would you like chicken with rice or a bean sandwich?

3. Customer: Change your drink from juice to water.

Answer: Could I have water instead of juice, please?

4. Server: Confirm chicken and water and state the total.

Answer: Chicken with rice and water. That is \$14.

5. Customer: End the exchange politely.

Answer: Thank you. Have a nice day.

Assessment guidance

Score each criterion 0-2: orders a food and drink politely; responds appropriately to an unavailable item; asks for the bill and checks the total. 4/6 indicates the task is substantially met. Intelligibility matters more than a perfect accent. This is a task rubric, not formal CEFR certification.

Support

Reduce the number of ideas to compare while keeping the same reasoning goal.

Sentence frames

- I would like ____, please.
- Do you have ____?
- Could I have the bill, please?

Word bank

- menu
- order
- water
- chicken
- bill

Worked examples

- Customer: I would like soup and water, please. Server: Sorry, we do not have soup. Customer: The bean sandwich, then. Server: A bean sandwich and water. That is nine dollars.

Smaller steps

- State the situation in one sentence.
- Select one relevant detail.
- Use a frame to explain the response.
- Add a limitation or another view.

Guided practice

- Make this polite: Give me water. Model: Could I have some water, please?
- Customer: Order two menu items and ask their total. Model: Example: A bean sandwich and water, please. How much is that? Total: \$9.

Challenge

Extend the same objective with less scaffolding and more independent explanation.

- Handle an incorrect bill politely.
- Repeat the role-play without reading the sentence frames.
- Which assumption does your response depend on?

- What evidence or constraint would change your choice?

Pacing: the package includes more practice than one class needs.

Teach the selected Version A tasks and keep Version B, extension work and the independent assessment for follow-up.

Sensitive or misleading assumptions.

Use imaginary preferences. Do not ask learners to reveal allergies, income or private health information. Menu prices are fictional.

Presentation - teaching notes

Teacher copy. Keep this guide separate from the student PowerPoint. Slide numbers below refer to the numbered lesson slides; an exported slide may continue over several pages.

1. Food at a Restaurant

Use a menu, make an order, handle one unavailable item, and ask for the bill.

Task: What do you already know about this topic?

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

2. Today's goal

Order a meal and a drink politely, respond to an unavailable item, and ask a server for the bill.

Task: Explain the goal in your own words.

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

3. menu

menu: A list of food and drinks.

Can I see the menu, please?

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "menu" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

4. order

order: Ask for food or drinks.

I would like to order.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "order" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

5. water

water: A drink.

Still water, please.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "water" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

6. chicken

chicken: A type of meat.

I would like the chicken.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "chicken" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

7. bill

bill: The list of what you need to pay.

Can I have the bill, please?

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "bill" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

8. Read and notice

Lunch at Cedar Café

Task: Which food is unavailable?

Teacher note: Use the full reading printed in both worksheet versions. Check the four reading questions against the separate teacher key.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

9. Listen for details

A Changed Order

Task: Listen once for the situation, then again for details.

Teacher note: Use the supplied recording or read the exact script in the separate listening teacher copy. Do not display the transcript during the listening check.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

10. Useful language

- I would like ____, please.
- Do you have ____?
- Could I have the bill, please?

Task: Adapt one frame to the situation.

Teacher note: These are language models, not answers to the reading or listening questions.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

11. Cedar Café role-play · 1

Menu: Chicken with rice \$12; vegetable soup \$6; bean sandwich \$7; water \$2; orange juice \$3. Prices include all charges for this fictional activity.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use imaginary preferences. Do not ask learners to reveal allergies, income or private health information. Menu prices are fictional.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

12. Cedar Café role-play · 2

Customer: You have \$15. Order food and a drink. Ask for the bill and check it.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use imaginary preferences. Do not ask learners to reveal allergies, income or private health information. Menu prices are fictional.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

13. Cedar Café role-play · 3

Server: Soup is unavailable. Offer another dish. Repeat the order and calculate the total.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use imaginary preferences. Do not ask learners to reveal allergies, income or private health information. Menu prices are fictional.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

14. Your final response

Order food and a drink. Ask for the bill.

Task: Check the total. Thank the server.

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.